A-A-419
October 1, 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RIBBON, TELETYPEWRITER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification DDD-R-306.

This commercial item description covers nylon fabric ribbon, to be used on teletypewriters.

Salient characteristics.

Weave. The fabric used shall have a regular commercial weave suitable for the purpose intended.

Edges. Ribbon edges shall be straight and parallel with the warp threads. To prevent fraying, edges of ribbons shall be fused.

Thickness and yarn count. Ribbon thickness and yarn count shall be as indicated below. ASTM D 1777 shall be used to determine thickness. Edges will not be used to determine fabric thickness.

Thickness (inches)	Total Yarn Count	Minimum Warp	Minimum Fill
	Threads Per Square Inch	Threads Per Inch	Threads Per Inch
0.0038 - 0.0042	277 - 296	165	112
0.0048 - 0.0052	272 - 286	164	108

Color. Ribbons shall be single-color or two-color as specified. Two-color ribbons shall have an equal width for each color, unless otherwise specified.

Inking. Ribbons shall be evenly inked. The division of two-color ribbons shall be clearly delineated, and neither color shall bleed into the other prior to or during ribbon use.

Length. Length shall be as specified and shall not be shorter than one-half inch for each yard of ribbon. Ribbons shall be furnished in continuous lengths without joining or splicing.

Width. Ribbon width shall be as specified. A tolerance of plus 1/64 inch, and minus 0.0 inch shall be permitted, provided print quality and ribbon operation are not affected.

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Spools, cartridges, and cores. Each ribbon shall be furnished on a metal or plastic spool, cartridge, or core for the specified machine. Metal, except aluminum, shall have an enamel, lacquer, or plated finish. Each ribbon shall be designed to operate satisfactorily with the ribbon feed and reversing mechanisms of the machine specified.

Performance. Ribbons shall produce clear, clean, and legible type impressions. There shall be no evidence of type filling. Type filling is the filling of the type face with fibers or ink from the ribbon, resulting in gradual broadening or feathering of typed impressions. There shall be no evidence of oil staining when ribbon impressions are examined.

Workmanship. Ribbons and their spools, cartridges, or cores shall be free from all defects that will affect performance and serviceability, or present a hazard to the user. Examples of ribbon defects are uneven weave, frayed edges, slits, and knots.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

NOTE. Purchasers shall indicate length, width, color, and inking (if other than specified in the CID) criteria in the procurement document.

Purchasers shall indicate the manufacturer's name and model number of the machine on which the ribbon will be used.

When this commercial item description is used for procurement, the commercial item certification clause must appear in the solicitation.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

MILITARY INTEREST:

NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in the commercial item description.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

NONE.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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